

Zac Truelove

Data Engineer · SQL Server Specialist

Chicago, IL truelovesql@gmail.com linkedin.com/in/ztruelove

SUMMARY

SQL Server specialist and data engineer with 20+ years of professional experience and more than a decade focused on database development, data warehousing, and ETL architecture. Proven record of measurable business impact — from cutting SQL Server infrastructure cost by 50% to automating processes that save hundreds of thousands of dollars annually. Equally comfortable owning critical systems end-to-end and collaborating across engineering and business teams; experienced in workload automation, source control, and modernization initiatives across healthcare, retail, and energy.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Databases

SQL Server, MySQL — design, development, optimization, administration

Languages

T-SQL (advanced), Python (working knowledge)

ETL & Integration

Stored-procedure pipelines, custom Python ETL frameworks, SSIS (legacy)

Performance Tuning

Index strategy, query optimization, execution-plan analysis, resource profiling

Workload Automation

ActiveBatch — design, development, and enterprise operations

Data Warehousing

Dimensional modeling, data integration patterns, reporting architecture

Cloud & Modern Stack

Snowflake, dbt, Azure — active migration involvement

Source Control

Git / Bitbucket, TFS

Reporting

Crystal Reports, ad-hoc analysis

Senior Data Engineer

2020 — Present

Medical Home Network · Chicago, IL

- Serve as the **sole SQL Server subject-matter expert**, owning database design, development, performance, and architecture for a healthcare data platform serving population health management programs.
- Reduced SQL Server CPU core utilization by **50%** through targeted index strategy improvements and query rewrites, generating tens of thousands of dollars in annual infrastructure savings.
- Led the migration of the ETL architecture from SSIS to a modernized solution built on stored procedures and a **Python integration framework**, converting dozens of packages over a 12-month effort.
- Solely accountable for enterprise workload automation in **ActiveBatch** — roughly 100 scheduled jobs with about 1,000 executions per day, with SLA compliance across all pipelines.
- Led the source-control migration from TFS to **Bitbucket (Git)**, including process design, documentation, and implementation.
- Built and maintained all integration pipelines and warehouse infrastructure supporting growth from **2 to 12+ client organizations** over five years; established standardized onboarding playbooks in Confluence.
- Actively participating in the organization's transition to a modern cloud data stack — **Snowflake, dbt, Azure**.

Staff Software Engineer, Enterprise Reporting & Analytics

2014 — 2020

Macy's Inc. · New York, NY

- Led all development and support for **Scorecard reporting** — the primary system measuring operational performance across Macy's retail locations and executive KPIs for reviews and compensation.
- Partnered with HR and Finance to build a database-driven manager-evaluation system, replacing a manual process and saving approximately **\$200,000 per year**.
- Directed a multi-year initiative consolidating **2,300+ Crystal Reports down to ~200**, then migrating them to modern reporting platforms — eliminating significant maintenance and licensing costs.
- Collaborated with HR, Finance, and Store Operations to define and validate the KPIs driving compensation and performance-review processes.

Senior Systems Developer

2005 — 2015

Southwestern Energy Company · Houston, TX

- Designed, developed, and maintained all reporting solutions for the Client Services department, supporting operational visibility across the IT organization.
- Built and maintained the enterprise **IT Service Management (ITSM)** platform.
- Developed a Purchase Request system with integrated budget and expenditure dashboards for on-demand financial analysis.

Bachelor of Business Administration, Computer Information Systems

University of Louisiana — Monroe